

INT. PAUL'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Simple but classy. Stylish furniture, distinctive touches.
Like straight out of a Pottery Barn ad.

Except for an oversized, weathered leather recliner.

Could it too have come from Pottery Barn, sold as distressed?
Nope, it's just old and worn, like it's current occupant.

PAUL KELLY, 60s, rumpled and tumbled from a lifetime of life,
reclines without a care in the world, reads a newspaper.

He glances at his watch. Pushes himself from the chair.

PAUL

As always...

The bottom cushion stays dented to the shape of his butt, an
indication that this scene has played out many times before.

PAUL (CONT'D)

You're welcome to--

MARY KELLY, 60s, sits on the nearby couch, nose in a book.

As opposed to Paul's lack of style, Mary has it going on. A
five foot nothing dynamo, she's proof that age is what you
make it.

MARY

And as always, I'll not go where
I'm not wanted.

PAUL

Where're you off to with that?

Mary holds up her copy of *The World According to Garp*.

MARY

Dog's Head Harbor. Worried about
the under-toad.

He turns to leave.

MARY (CONT'D)

Come home to me Paul Kelly. Don't
spend all your week's wages. And
don't be stinking of beer, either.

Paul considers her request as he opens the front door.

PAUL

You can't have all three.

As the door shuts, Mary rises from her seat, a mischievous glint in her eye.

Reaches into his recliner. Exposes a small, RED HEART TATTOO on the inside of her wrist.

Pulls out a weathered leather wallet with a circular condom ring on one side. Takes the cash from it. Settles back onto the couch with her book.

MARY

We'll see about that.

EXT. CITY STREET - NIGHT

Paul walks a quiet, empty sidewalk. Lights flicker from working class homes.

A screen door slams behind him. Footsteps. Paul freezes. A moment of anxiety, he slowly glances over his shoulder. A NEIGHBOR on a porch lights a cigarette, nods to him.

NEIGHBOR

Longo's later?

Paul points finger guns at him.

PAUL

You got that right.

EXT. WILT'S TAP - NIGHT

One dim light above the entrance.

Two white teenage TOUGHS loiter.

TOUGH 1

Mr. Friday night. 'Sup?

Paul tenses. A flicker of anger in his eyes, then it's gone.

PAUL

You douche bags have homes?

He steps around Tough 1, Tough 2 blocks his way.

TOUGH 2

Buy us a bottle.

Moves to pass Tough 2. Tough 1 steps back in the way.

PAUL
Don't think you need it. You're
probably already on dope.

The Toughs crack up.

	TOUGH 2	TOUGH 1
On dope?		What century do you live in?

Paul sees his chance. Sneaks in the front door.

INT. WILT'S TAP - CONTINUOUS

Paul takes in the place. Dark. Barebones. Lonely and sad.

DONNIE DRAKE, 30s, tends bar to a handful of regulars. He looks older than he is, stuck in a job that requires people skills, which he sorely lacks.

PAUL
You should do something about those
pendejos.

DONNIE
They're harmless. No different than
you or me at that age.

Donnie pulls a draft beer.

PAUL
You, maybe. They're lucky I--

 DONNIE
Yeah, yeah, yeah. Back in your day.
Blah, blah, blah.

Donnie slides Paul the draft.

DONNIE (CONT'D)
Drink your two beers and git.

Paul takes the beer, a little miffed.

INT. WILT'S TAP - LATER

Paul hands his glass to Donnie while he holds court between two regulars. He's animated, they're bored.

PAUL
If she says it doesn't taste bad,
hold onto that gal forever.

He laughs at his own story. The regulars groan.

Donnie hands Paul a new beer. He takes a sip, reaches for his wallet - oops.

DONNIE

How many times you gotta tell that?

PAUL

It seems I forgot my wallet.

Donnie scoops up the beer. Dumps it.

DONNIE

Go. Get out of here.

PAUL

I'm good for it.

DONNIE

Don't care. Just go.

PAUL

How long have I been coming here?

DONNIE

Every Friday night. Forever. You have two here, off to Lucky's for two. Then Longo's after that.

PAUL

How about some respect for--

DONNIE

Do I have it right? Know what your problem is? Diarrhea of the mouth.

PAUL

-- twenty years of--

DONNIE

Let me ask you this. Why can't I find anyone to corroborate any of your "stories?" Not one.

Before Paul can answer.

DONNIE (CONT'D)

'Cause they're bullshit. And don't think I won't call Rick and Bennie, either. Let them know.

Paul wants to argue but lacks the energy. Turns for the back.

DONNIE (CONT'D)
Where you going?

PAUL
The side door, avoid the douche
bags. Give me that at least.

EXT. WILT'S TAP - PARKING LOT - CONTINUOUS

Paul stands next to a sweet Camaro. Catches himself in the driver side window reflection. Smirks.

Snaps off the sideview mirror. It dangles on the car door.

PAUL
Fuck you, Donnie.

EXT. LUCKY'S - NIGHT

Neon beer signs glow from small windows near the entrance.

RICK PULASKI, 50s, locks up as Paul arrives. He looks hard with a shaved head and goatee, he's really just a teddybear.

PAUL
I guess you heard?

RICK
Yup. And Donnie's a dick.

PAUL
It's not my night.

RICK
We're dead, I'm closing early.
Plus, I haven't had a Friday night
off in years.

PAUL
Good man, wet finger the wind and
keep your ear to the ground.

RICK
Sorry if this messes with your
routine. You off to see Bennie?

INT. LONGO'S - NIGHT

Brightly lit, festive and lively. Three generations of pictures, pop culture and artwork fill the room. The jukebox plays for happy customers.